SETUP GUIDE

365center-mcp Installation & Setup

Complete step-by-step guide to install and configure the Microsoft 365 / SharePoint MCP server for Claude Desktop and Claude Code.

Available on GitHub · npm · Docker Hub · cristianb.cz

VERSION	UPDATED	AUTHOR
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Table of Contents

Introduction

Prerequisites

Part 1 — Azure Setup

- Step 1 — Sign in to Azure Portal
- Step 2 — Find Microsoft Entra ID
- Step 3 — Open App registrations
- Step 4 — Register a new application
- Step 5 — Copy IDs and open Certificates & secrets
- Step 6 — Create a new client secret
- Step 7 — Copy the secret value immediately
- Step 8 — Add Microsoft Graph permissions
- Step 9 — Add SharePoint permission
- Step 10 — Grant admin consent
- Step 11 — Enable public client flows

Part 2 — Installation

- Option A — Docker (recommended)
- Option B — npx (easiest)
- Option C — Node.js from source

Using Claude Code instead of Claude Desktop

Part 3 — First-time login

Part 4 — Troubleshooting

Introduction

365center-mcp is a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server that gives Claude Desktop and Claude Code full read/write access to Microsoft 365 SharePoint sites. With 33 tools across sites, documents, pages, metadata, navigation, and permissions, Claude can manage your SharePoint tenant through natural conversation — uploading files, creating pages, tagging documents, managing access, and more.

Available on GitHub, npm, and Docker Hub. For the full README, all configuration options, and the latest updates, visit the GitHub repository.

This guide walks you through every step needed to get it running, from creating the Azure App Registration that authenticates the server, to installing the server itself via Docker, npx, or Node.js from source. No prior Azure experience needed — every click is explained.

> WHO THIS GUIDE IS FOR
>
> You are an IT administrator, developer, or power user who wants to connect Claude to Microsoft 365 / SharePoint. You do not need to know Azure, TypeScript, or Docker in advance — this guide explains each step from scratch.

Before you start

Make sure you have all of these ready before beginning. Each item has a link where to get it.

1. A Claude account

Any plan works — Free, Pro, or Max. Sign up at claude.ai if you do not have one yet.

2. Claude Desktop (or Claude Code)

You need a Claude client on your computer to connect to MCP servers. This guide focuses on **Claude Desktop**, but Claude Code works too. Both are official Anthropic products — use the links below for official installation instructions.

- **Claude Desktop** (Mac / Windows) — normal desktop application, installed by clicking through the setup wizard.
  - Download: claude.com/download
  - Official install guide: support.claude.com — Install Claude Desktop

- **Claude Code** (CLI, for developers) — terminal-based client. MCP setup works differently: instead of editing a JSON config file, you run `claude mcp add`.
  - Official setup guide: code.claude.com/docs/en/setup

3. A Microsoft 365 Business tenant

You need a real **Microsoft 365 Business tenant** (Business Basic, Business Standard, or Business Premium) with SharePoint Online. Personal Microsoft accounts (outlook.com, hotmail.com) will **not work** — 365center-mcp only supports work/school accounts.

You must also have **Global Administrator** or **Privileged Role Administrator** access to this tenant (required to grant admin consent in Azure), and at least one **SharePoint site** you want to manage.

4. Runtime for the MCP server

Depending on which installation method you choose in Part 2, install one of these on your computer:

- **Docker Desktop** — recommended, easiest to set up. Download from docker.com/products/docker-desktop. Normal installer (`.dmg` on Mac, `.exe` on Windows).
- **Node.js 18 or newer** — if you prefer not to use Docker. Download from nodejs.org. Also a normal installer, click through setup.

> ABOUT MICROSOFT ENTRA ID
>
> Your M365 tenant automatically includes Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) — that is where you will create the App Registration in Part 1. You do NOT need a separate Azure subscription. App Registrations are free and included with every M365 tenant.

PART 1

Azure Setup

Create an Azure App Registration, configure API permissions, and enable the settings that 365center-mcp needs to authenticate with Microsoft Graph and SharePoint REST API. This takes about 10 minutes the first time.

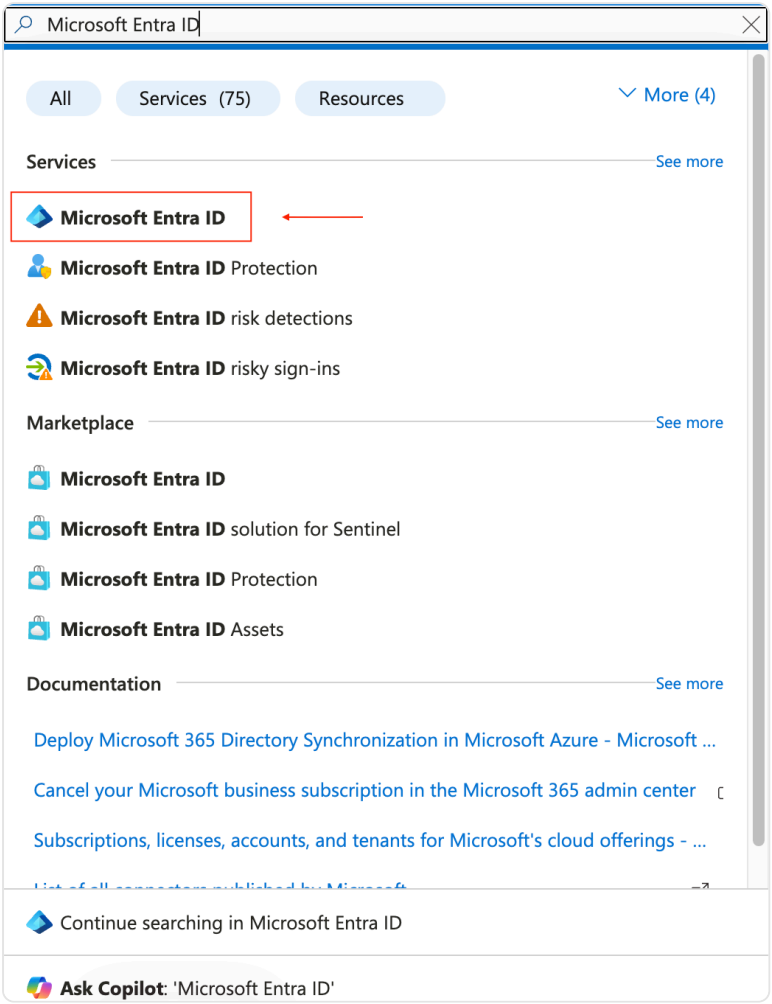
1 Sign in to Azure Portal

Open portal.azure.com in your browser and sign in with your Microsoft 365 account. You must use an account that has **Global Administrator** access to your tenant.

2 Find Microsoft Entra ID

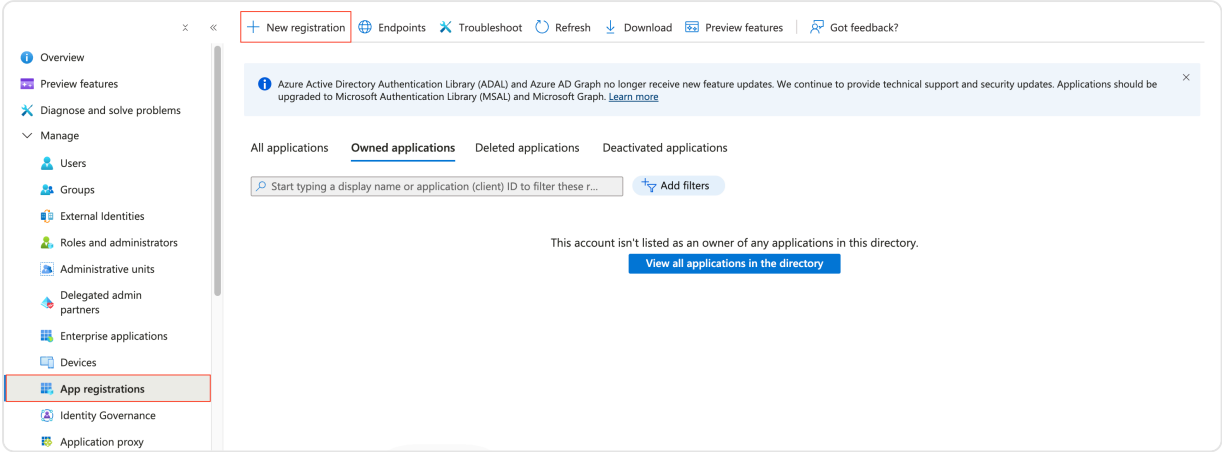
In the top search bar, type `Microsoft Entra ID` and click the first result under the **Services** section — the one with the blue diamond icon.

Do not click "Microsoft Entra ID Protection", "risky workload identities", or any result from the **Marketplace** section — those are different products.



3 Open App registrations

In the Entra ID left sidebar, expand the **Manage** section and click **App registrations**. Then click **+ New registration** at the top of the page.

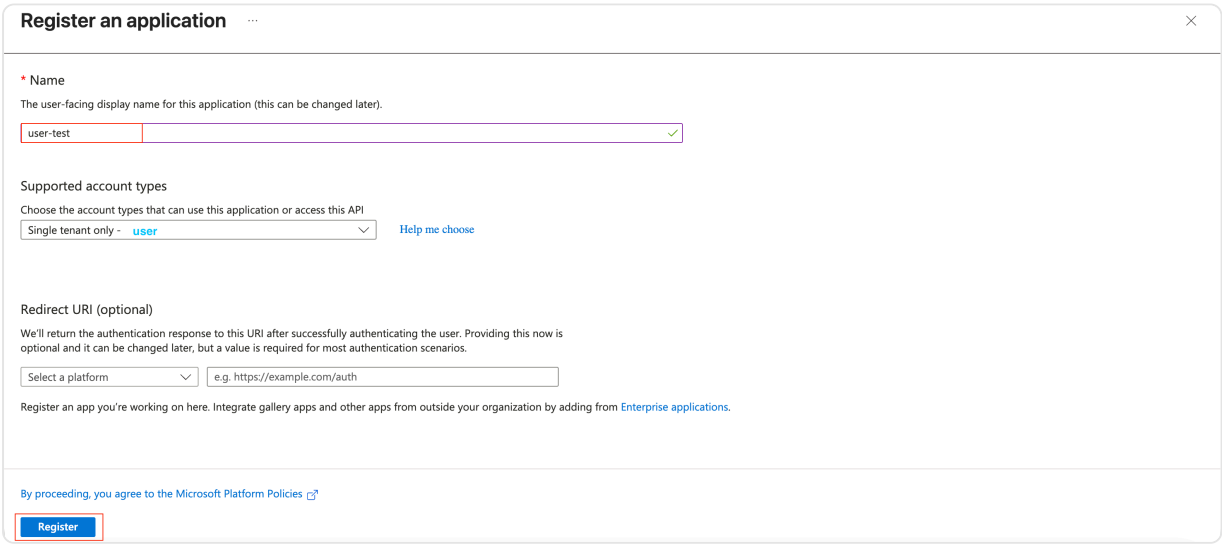


4 Register a new application

Fill in the registration form:

- **Name** — any name you like, for example `365center-mcp`. You can change it later.
- **Supported account types** — select **Accounts in this organizational directory only (Single tenant)**.
- **Redirect URI** — leave empty.

Click **Register** at the bottom of the form.

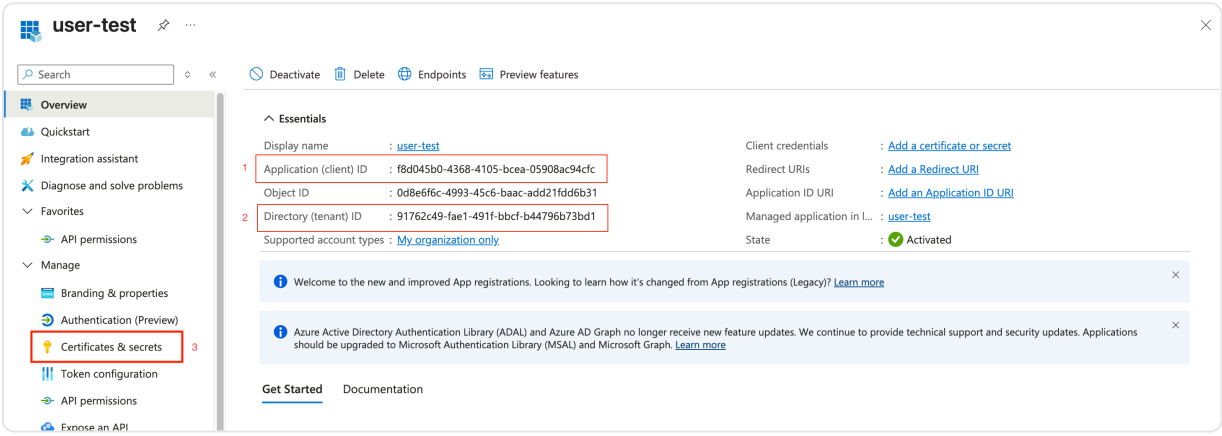


5 Copy IDs and open Certificates & secrets

You are now on the Overview page of your new application. There are two important values you need to copy and save now:

1. Copy the **Application (client) ID** — this is your `AZURE_CLIENT_ID`.
2. Copy the **Directory (tenant) ID** — this is your `AZURE_TENANT_ID`.
3. Then click **Certificates & secrets** in the left sidebar under Manage.

Save both IDs somewhere safe (a notepad or a password manager). You will need them later when configuring Claude Desktop.

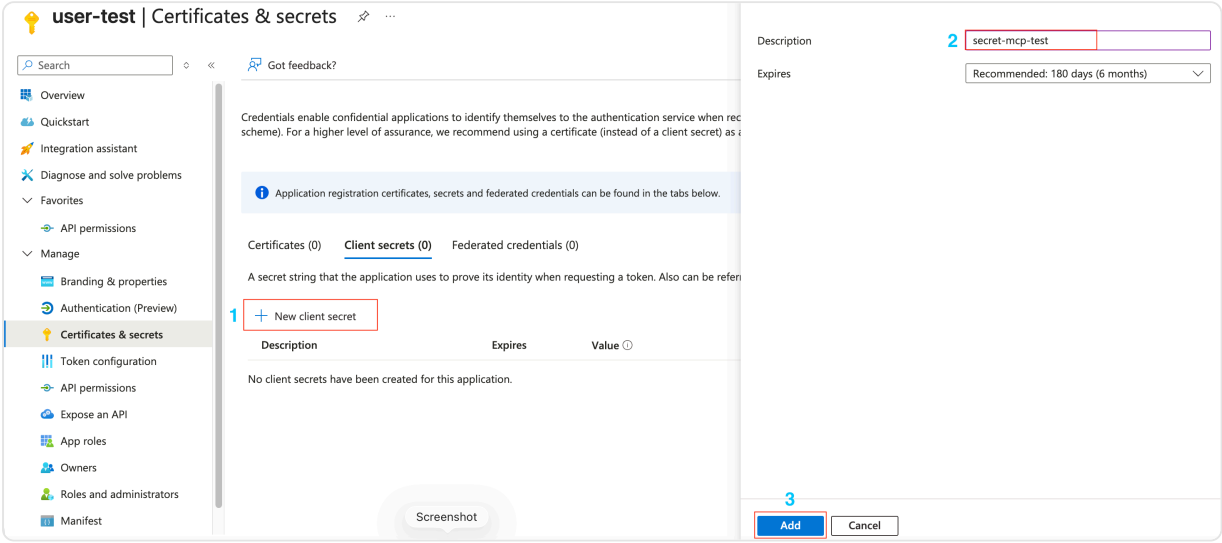


6 Create a new client secret

On the Certificates & secrets page, under the **Client secrets** tab:

1. Click **+ New client secret**.
2. Enter a description (for example `mcp-secret`).
3. Click **Add** at the bottom of the panel.

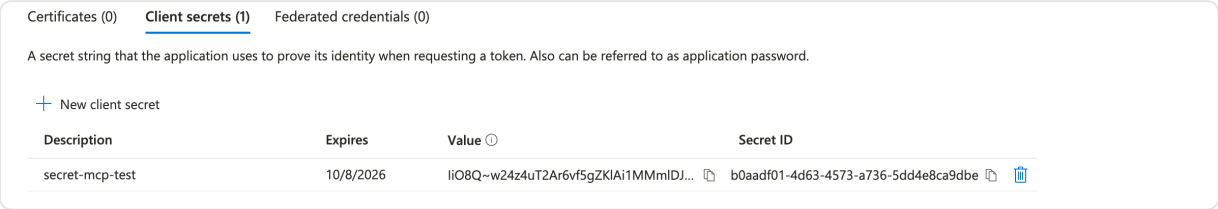
For **Expires**, you can keep the default (6 months) or choose a longer duration up to 24 months. A longer duration means you will not have to create a new secret as often.



7 Copy the secret value immediately

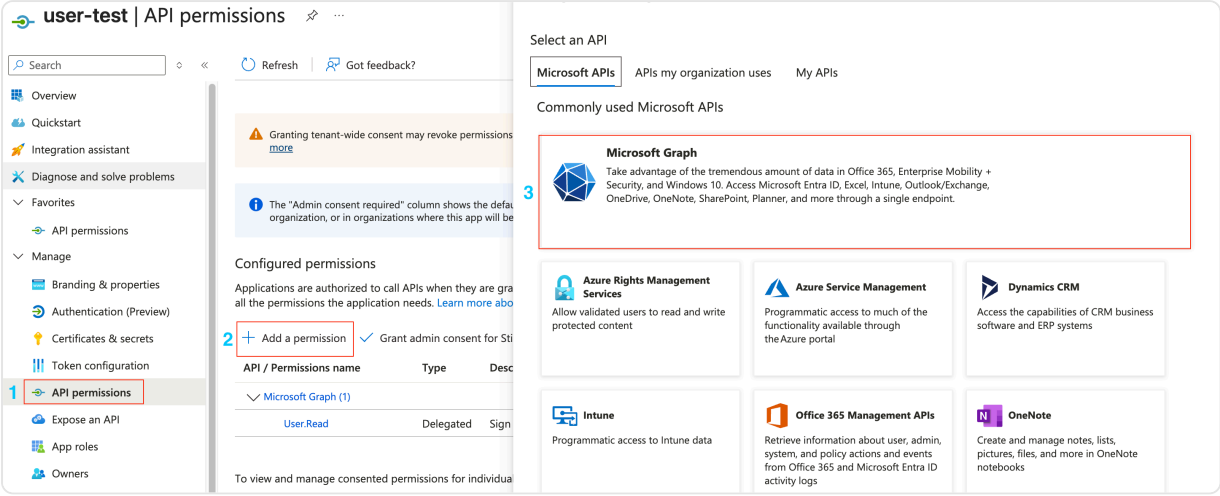
After clicking Add, the new secret appears in the list with its **Value** visible. Copy the Value now and save it securely — this is your `AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET`.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Copy the **VALUE** column, not the **SECRET ID** column. Value is the long string starting with a tilde (`~`). Once you leave this page, Value can never be shown again. If you lose it, you must create a new secret.



8 Add Microsoft Graph permissions

Click **API permissions** in the left sidebar, then click **+ Add a permission** and choose **Microsoft Graph**.



You need to add two sets of Graph permissions. Add the first set, then repeat **+ Add a permission → Microsoft Graph** again for the second set.

Application permissions (4)

Choose **Application permissions** and add these four, then click **Add permissions**:

- `Files.ReadWrite.All`
- `Sites.FullControl.All`
- `Sites.Manage.All`
- `Sites.ReadWrite.All`

Delegated permissions (3)

Click **+ Add a permission → Microsoft Graph** again, this time choose **Delegated permissions** and add:

- `offline_access`
- `Sites.FullControl.All`
- `Sites.ReadWrite.All`

Click **Add permissions**.

9 Add SharePoint permission

Click **+ Add a permission** one more time. This time choose **SharePoint** (not Microsoft Graph — these are two different APIs).

Choose **Delegated permissions** and add:

- `AllSites.FullControl`

Click **Add permissions**.

10 Grant admin consent

After adding all the permissions from Steps 8 and 9, your configured permissions list should match the screenshot below: **8 Microsoft Graph entries** and **1 SharePoint entry**.

Click **Grant admin consent** at the top of the permissions list and confirm. All permissions should turn green (Granted) afterwards.

> **BUTTON IS GRAYED OUT?**
>
> If Grant admin consent is disabled, your account does not have administrator privileges. Ask your Global Administrator to complete this step for you.

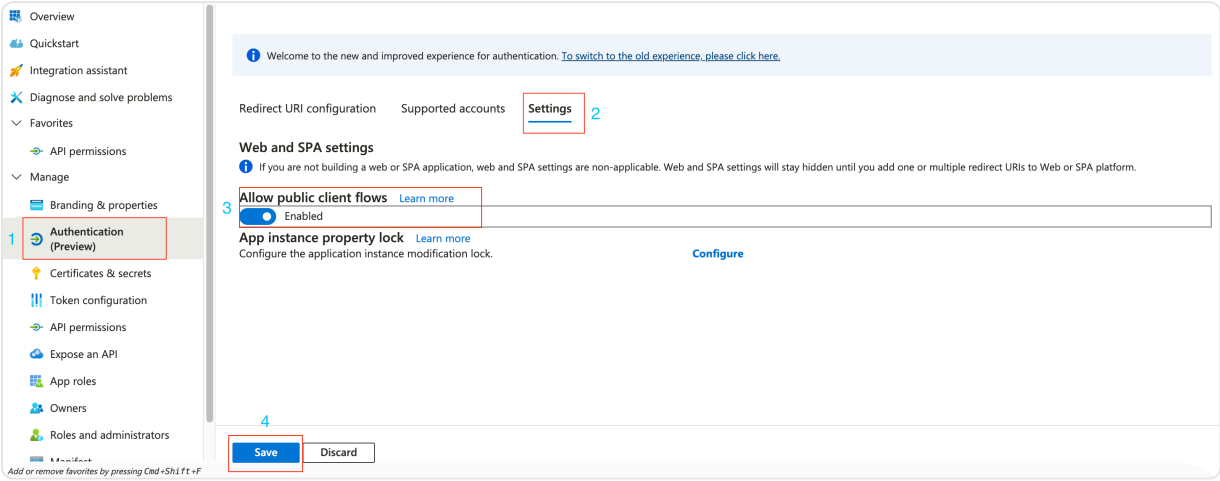
+ Add a permission | ✓ Grant admin consent for user

API / Permissions name	Type	Description	Admin consent requ...
Microsoft Graph (8)			
Files.ReadWrite.All	Application	Read and write files in all site collections	Yes
offline_access	Delegated	Maintain access to data you have given it access to	No
Sites.FullControl.All	Delegated	Have full control of all site collections	Yes
Sites.FullControl.All	Application	Have full control of all site collections	Yes
Sites.Manage.All	Application	Create, edit, and delete items and lists in all site collections	Yes
Sites.ReadWrite.All	Delegated	Edit or delete items in all site collections	No
Sites.ReadWrite.All	Application	Read and write items in all site collections	Yes
User.Read	Delegated	Sign in and read user profile	No
SharePoint (1)			
AllSites.FullControl	Delegated	Have full control of all site collections	Yes

11 Enable public client flows

Click **Authentication** in the left sidebar, open the **Settings** tab, then turn on **Allow public client flows** and click **Save**.

> **WHY THIS MATTERS**
>
> This setting enables the device code flow login used by tools that act on behalf of a signed-in user (navigation, permissions, user management, Highlighted Content web part). Without it, Claude cannot complete the one-time login when you first use one of these tools.



Azure setup complete

You should now have all four values saved somewhere safe:

Environment variable	Where it came from
`AZURE_TENANT_ID`	Step 5 — Directory (tenant) ID
`AZURE_CLIENT_ID`	Step 5 — Application (client) ID
`AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET`	Step 7 — Secret Value
`SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN`	Your SharePoint domain, e.g. `contoso.sharepoint.com`

Keep these ready — you will paste them into your Claude Desktop configuration in Part 2.

PART 2

Installation

Three ways to run 365center-mcp, from easiest to most flexible. Pick one — you do not need to install all three.

> **ABOUT DEPENDENCIES**
>
> All three options automatically download 365center-mcp and its runtime dependencies (MCP SDK, Azure identity, Microsoft Graph client, dotenv). You do not need to install any of these manually — your chosen method handles it for you.

Option A — Docker (recommended)

The most portable option. Runs the server in an isolated container — no Node.js needed on your machine. Requires Docker Desktop to be installed and running.

1. Quit Claude Desktop

Before editing the config, quit Claude Desktop completely from the menu bar (not just close the window). Editing the config while Claude Desktop is still running means your changes will not be picked up until the next full restart.

2. Pull the image from Docker Hub

The easiest way is through Docker Desktop directly — no terminal needed:

1. Open Docker Desktop.
2. Click **Docker Hub** in the left sidebar.
3. In the search box, type `365center-mcp`.
4. Click the result published by **crscristi28** — the full name is `crscristi28/365center-mcp`. This is the official image.
5. Click **Pull** next to the `latest` tag.
6. Wait about 30 seconds for the download to finish.

Alternative for developers who prefer the terminal:

```
docker pull crscristi28/365center-mcp:latest
```

3. Open Claude Desktop config file

- **Mac:** `~/Library/Application Support/Claude/claude_desktop_config.json`
- **Windows:** `%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`

4. Paste the entry and fill in your Azure values

Add the entry below to the file. The text `<your-server-name>` is just a label you choose yourself — it can be anything, for example `sharepoint` or `my-mcp`. Claude will use this name to show the server in its menu. Fill in the rest with your Azure values from Part 1.

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "<your-server-name>": {
      "command": "docker",
      "args": [
        "run", "-i", "--rm",
        "-e", "AZURE_TENANT_ID=your-tenant-id",
        "-e", "AZURE_CLIENT_ID=your-client-id",
        "-e", "AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET=your-client-secret",
        "-e", "SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN=your-domain.sharepoint.com",
        "-v", "/Users/YOUR_USERNAME/.365center-mcp:/home/mcp/.365center-mcp",
        "crscristi28/365center-mcp:latest"
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

> **WHY THE VOLUME MOUNT?**
>
> The server caches delegated authentication tokens in `~/.365center-mcp/token-cache.json`. Without the `-v` volume mount, you would have to re-authenticate every time Docker restarts.

5. Save and open Claude Desktop

Save the config file and open Claude Desktop. The server will appear in the MCP menu with all 33 tools loaded.

Option B — npx (easiest, no manual download)

This is the simplest method. You do not download anything yourself — just edit the Claude Desktop config and restart the app. Claude Desktop will call `npx` automatically, which downloads 365center-mcp and its dependencies from npm the first time it runs.

Requires Node.js 18 or newer installed on your machine.

1. Quit Claude Desktop

Quit Claude Desktop completely from the menu bar (not just close the window).

2. Open Claude Desktop config file

- **Mac:** `~/Library/Application Support/Claude/claude_desktop_config.json`
- **Windows:** `%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`

3. Paste the entry and fill in your Azure values

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "<your-server-name>": {
      "command": "npx",
      "args": ["-y", "365center-mcp"],
      "env": {
        "AZURE_TENANT_ID": "your-tenant-id",
        "AZURE_CLIENT_ID": "your-client-id",
        "AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET": "your-client-secret",
        "SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN": "your-domain.sharepoint.com"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

> **NPX CONFIG IS DIFFERENT FROM DOCKER CONFIG**
>
> With npx, environment variables go in a separate `env` object, not as `-e` flags in the `args` array. This is because npx runs directly on your host machine as a Node process, while Docker passes variables into the container. If you are switching from Docker to npx (or vice versa), replace the entire entry — do not just change the `command` field.

4. Save and open Claude Desktop

Save the config file and open Claude Desktop. The first start takes about 15–30 seconds longer than usual — that is npx downloading 365center-mcp from npm. Subsequent starts are instant because the package is cached locally.

Option C — Node.js from source

For developers who want to modify the code. Requires Node.js 18 or newer and Git.

1. Quit Claude Desktop

Quit Claude Desktop completely from the menu bar (not just close the window).

2. Clone the repository and build

```
git clone https://github.com/Crscristi28/365center-mcp.git
cd 365center-mcp/mcp-server
npm install
npm run build
```

3. Create a `.env` file

In the `mcp-server/` directory, create a file named `.env` with your Azure credentials:

```
AZURE_TENANT_ID=your-tenant-id
AZURE_CLIENT_ID=your-client-id
AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET=your-client-secret
SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN=your-domain.sharepoint.com
```

4. Test that the server runs

```
node dist/index.js
```

The server should start and wait silently for input on stdin. Press Ctrl+C to stop it.

5. Add it to Claude Desktop

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "<your-server-name>": {
      "command": "node",
      "args": ["/absolute/path/to/mcp-server/dist/index.js"],
      "env": {
        "AZURE_TENANT_ID": "your-tenant-id",
        "AZURE_CLIENT_ID": "your-client-id",
        "AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET": "your-client-secret",
        "SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN": "your-domain.sharepoint.com"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Replace the path with the full absolute path to `dist/index.js` on your machine. Save the config file and open Claude Desktop — the server will appear in the MCP menu.

Using Claude Code instead of Claude Desktop

Claude Code is Anthropic's CLI client. Instead of editing a JSON config file, MCP servers are added with the `claude mcp add` command. You have two ways to set up 365center-mcp in Claude Code — let Claude Code do it for you, or run the command yourself.

Easiest way — let Claude Code set it up for you

Once Claude Code is installed, open it in your terminal and paste the message below. Replace the four placeholder values with your Azure credentials from Part 1.

```
Please install the 365center-mcp MCP server for me.
You can find it on npm as "365center-mcp" or at
github.com/Crscristi28/365center-mcp. Use the npx method.

My Azure credentials:
AZURE_TENANT_ID=your-tenant-id
AZURE_CLIENT_ID=your-client-id
AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET=your-client-secret
SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN=your-domain.sharepoint.com
```

Claude Code will look up the package, run the right `claude mcp add` command with your values, and confirm the server is registered. If it asks you which installation method you prefer (Docker, npx, or Node.js from source), pick whichever you like — all three work the same way as in Options A, B, and C above.

Manual way — run the command yourself

If you prefer to run the command directly, here is the npx version (the most common):

```
claude mcp add <your-server-name> \
  -e AZURE_TENANT_ID=your-tenant-id \
  -e AZURE_CLIENT_ID=your-client-id \
  -e AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET=your-client-secret \
  -e SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN=your-domain.sharepoint.com \
  -- npx -y 365center-mcp
```

For the Docker and Node.js from source variants, or the full `claude mcp add` reference, see the official Claude Code MCP docs at code.claude.com/docs/en/setup.

PART 3

First-time login (device code flow)

Most of the 33 tools work immediately after installation. A handful of them need an additional one-time login.

Most tools in 365center-mcp use **application authentication**, which works automatically with your client secret — no user interaction needed. But some features (navigation, permissions, Highlighted Content web part) require **delegated authentication**, which means Claude must act as a signed-in user.

The first time you ask Claude to call one of these tools, you will see a message like:

```
LOGIN REQUIRED: To sign in, use a web browser to open the page
https://microsoft.com/devicelogin and enter the code ABC123XYZ
to authenticate.
```

What to do

1. Open microsoft.com/devicelogin in any browser.
2. Enter the code shown in Claude's message.
3. Sign in with your Microsoft 365 account.
4. Close the browser tab.
5. Ask Claude to try the same action again — it will now succeed.

The login is cached locally in `~/.365center-mcp/token-cache.json` along with a refresh token, so you only have to do this once. The server automatically refreshes tokens in the background as they expire.

> **FOR DOCKER USERS**
>
> The `-v` volume mount in your Docker configuration preserves the token cache across container restarts. Without it, you would have to repeat the device code flow every time Docker restarts.

PART 4

Troubleshooting

Common errors and how to fix them.

"Insufficient privileges to complete the operation"

You missed an API permission or admin consent was not granted. Go back to **Step 10** of the Azure Setup and make sure **Grant admin consent** shows a green checkmark next to every permission.

"AADSTS7000215: Invalid client secret provided"

Your `AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET` is wrong or expired. Go back to **Step 6** and create a new secret. Make sure you copied the **Value** column, not the **Secret ID** column.

"SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN environment variable is required"

You forgot to set `SHAREPOINT_DOMAIN`. It should be your SharePoint domain only, without `https://` and without any path. For example: `contoso.sharepoint.com`.

"LOGIN REQUIRED: To sign in, use a web browser..."

This is expected the first time you use a tool that requires delegated authentication. See **Part 3 — First-time login**.

"Device code auth failed: authorization_declined"

You declined the sign-in prompt in the browser, or signed in with an account that does not have access to the target SharePoint site. Try again with the correct account.

"Token refresh failed"

Your refresh token expired or was revoked. Delete the file `~/.365center-mcp/token-cache.json` and trigger the device code flow again by calling any tool that requires delegated authentication.

"Allow public client flows" is not available

You are probably signed in with a Personal Microsoft account, not a work/school account. 365center-mcp requires a work/school account connected to a real Microsoft 365 Business tenant.

Docker: tokens lost on every restart

You forgot the `-v` volume mount in your Docker configuration. Without it, the container has no place to persist the token cache between restarts. See **Part 2 — Option A**.

Claude Desktop does not see the server

- Check your JSON syntax — a missing comma or bracket will silently break the config.
- Restart Claude Desktop *fully* (quit from the menu bar, not just close the window).
- Check Claude Desktop logs: **Help → View logs** on Mac, or `%APPDATA%\Claude\logs` on Windows.